

CAULK, SEAL & WEATHERPROOF

How to Stop Leaks, Kill Drafts, and Lower Your Bills

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Introduction

Weatherproofing is the art of sealing gaps. It's one of the highest-return DIY tasks you can perform. For the cost of a \$10 tube of caulk, you can prevent expensive water damage and save up to 15% on your energy bills.

Average ROI: 1 hour of work = \$200+ annual savings.

Caulking the Bath & Shower

If the caulk around your tub is peeling or missing, water is getting behind your walls.

PRO SECRET

The Soap Trick: After applying a bead of caulk, dip your finger in soapy water before smoothing it. This prevents the caulk from sticking to your finger and creates a perfect, professional finish.

- Remove old caulk completely.
- Clean with rubbing alcohol.
- Apply a 45-degree bead and smooth immediately.

Stopping Window Drafts

On a windy day, use a stick of incense to find leaks. Smoke dancing near the frame indicates a draft.

1. **Rope Caulk:** Press this putty-like strip into gaps for an instant, removable seal.
2. **Shrink Film:** Apply clear plastic film and use a hair dryer to create an airtight insulation layer.

The Secret Outlet Draft

Cold air often blows through electrical outlets on exterior walls. Buy foam "Outlet Gaskets" and install them behind the plastic cover plates. It takes 30 seconds and stops a surprising amount of heat loss.